[INCH - POUND]

A-A-2656
May 9, 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TAB, SIGNAL, PLASTIC
TAB SET, SIGNAL, PLASTIC

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Federal Specification L-T-30 which has been cancelled.

This commercial item description covers plastic signal tabs and tab sets. Tabs shall be designed for use with visible file cards.

Classification. Tabs shall be non projection type and shall be of the following classes, and colors as specified (see Section 7):

Class A - Transparent, Crimped without cut out.
Class B - Metal Reinforced.
Color - 1 - Blue
2 - Green
3 - Orange
4 - Red
5 - Yellow

1. Salient Characteristics

A. Tabs shall be designed for use with visible file cards.

B. Class A, transparent tabs shall be rectangular in shape. The tabs shall be made of any commercially acceptable plastic and shall be 0.010 inch ± 0.001 inch thick. The transparency of the plastic shall be such that signal tabs will not perceptibly diminish the visibility of printed matter. The tabs shall be furnished as individual signals or in scored strips. Tabs in strip form shall break cleanly and evenly at scoring. One end of the tab shall be crimped so that they will lock on pocket file cards, can easily be slid to another position on cards, and removed entirely without removing cards from pockets. The tabs shall be 7/8 inch ± 1/16 inch long and 1/4 inch ± 1/32 inch wide. Tabs shall be furnished in blue, green, orange, red or yellow, as specified (See Section 7).

C. Class B, tabs shall be made of transparent plastic reinforced with metal. The tabs shall be made of any commercially acceptable plastic and shall be 0.010 inch ± 0.001 inch thick. The metal used shall not be affected by the test in section 2. The reinforcement may be in the form of a flat piece of formed metal, or two strands of wire parallel to the longer dimension and imbedded between two sheets of plastic. When tabs are made of two sheets of

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

plastic, the total thickness of both sheets shall be 0.010 inch ± 0.001 inch thick and wires shall be no more than 1/8 inch but less than 3/16 inch apart. Except for the open end, the tabs shall be rectangular in shape. The transparency of the plastic shall be such that signal tabs will not perceptibly diminish the visibility of printed matter. The tabs shall be furnished as individual signals or in scored strips. Tabs in strip form shall break cleanly and evenly at scoring. The edges of the tabs shall be free from metal projections which might constitute a personal hazard to the user. The tabs shall be 7/8 inch ± 3/16 inch long and 5/16 inch ± 1/32 inch wide. Tabs shall be furnished in blue, green, red or yellow as specified (See Section 7).

D. Tab sets, when required, shall be as specified (See Section 7).

E. Legends. Tabs and tab sets, when required, shall be lettered or numbered as specified. Unless, otherwise specified, letters and numbers shall be black (See Section 7).

Workmanship. The tab's edges shall be clean cut and smooth. The tabs shall be free from any defects which may affect their appearance, serviceability or present a hazard to the user.

2. Test (Class B only)

Grip Performance. Slide tab over paperboard with a thickness of 0.012 inch ± 0.0005 inch. Remove the tab and slide over a single sheet of manifold paper with a thickness of 0.0015 inch ± 0.0005 inch. Remove and examine the tab. The metal used for reinforcing shall be such that the grip of the reinforced tabs are not affected by this test.

3. Quality Assurance

Each lot of tabs shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the plans specified below.

A. Sampling for visual and dimensional examination - Inspection Level I with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one tab.

B. Test (Class B only) - Inspection Level S-1 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one tab.

C. Packaging, Packing, and Marking - Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container.

4. Preparation for delivery

Packaging, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein:
The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be apply.

MIL-STD-105 is available from Naval Publications and Forms Center; 5801 Tabor Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19120.

6. Recovered materials

The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

7. Notes

A. Ordering Data:
Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Class.
(b) Color of tabs.
(c) Tab sets, if required.
(d) Lettering or numbering, if required.
(e) Packaging, packing and marking.

B. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (For Cataloging Use Only)

AA2656 - A 1 : This example describes a transparent crimped without cut out, blue plastic signal tab in accordance with CID A-A-2656.

Color 1 - Blue
2 - Green
3 - Orange
4 - Red
5 - Yellow

Class A- Transparent, Crimped without cut out.
B - Metal Reinforced.

8. Cross Reference Data

INT FED SPEC L-T-0030	CID A-A-2656
Type I, Class A, Style 1	Class A
Type I, Class A, Style 2	Obsolete
Type I, Class A, Style 3	Obsolete
Type I, Class B	Obsolete
Type I, Class C	Class B
Type II	Obsolete

DOD has registered no official interest.

Preparing Activity:

GSA/FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.